

ECON/FINC 3820: Money and Banking

Fall, 2026

Instructor:	Colin Adams
Email:	Colin.Adams@gcsu.edu
Student Hours:	Tuesday and Thursday at 11am–1:30pm, or by appointment
Office:	Atkinson Hall 417B
Prerequisites:	ECON 2105 & ECON 2106 or ECON 2100

Course Description

A study of the nature of money and of the development of banking in the U.S. Considerations of the functions of money, modern financial institutions, the Federal Reserve System, and foreign exchange.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, students should be able to:

- Explain the structure and goals of the Federal Reserve, and how it changes the money supply.
- Explain how banks create money.
- Analyze how the federal funds rate is determined and how it drives interest rates.
- Apply time value of money concepts to price stocks and bonds.
- Evaluate the Efficient Market Hypothesis and its implications for investing.

Textbook(s) and Other Resources

Recommended Other Resources

- Cecchetti, S. and Schoenholtz, K. *Money, Banking, and Financial Markets*. Any edition is acceptable.
- Practice materials posted on GAView
- Brent Evans's Money and Banking videos on YouTube [here](#)

Grading

Final grades will be based on three in-person exams and quizzes administered through GAView.

Grading Breakdown		
Assignment	Percent of Total Grade	Date
Exam 1	26	9/24/2026
Exam 2	26	11/05/2026
Final Exam	26	See schedule
Quizzes	22	See schedule

Grading Scale

Letter grade	Percent
A	89.50 - 100
B	79.50 - 89.49
C	69.50 - 79.49
D	59.50 - 69.49
F	0 - 59.49

Exams

This course includes three exams, including a cumulative final. Each exam counts for 26% of your final grade and covers material from both the readings and lectures. The first two exams will take place during regular class time; the final exam will be held in our classroom during the university-designated final exam period.

Exam Policies

- No electronic devices (cell phones, smart watches, headphones, tablets, etc.) may be used, seen, or accessed during an exam. Any violation will be treated as cheating.
- Only scientific, four-function, and financial calculators are allowed; graphing calculators are not. Bring your own, as I will not provide one. I may inspect any calculator before, during, or after the exam.
- Exams are closed book and closed notes; no outside materials, talking, or sharing of calculators, pencils, or scratch paper is permitted once the exam begins.
- If you leave the room before submitting your exam, for any reason, you must leave all electronic devices behind.
- No student may begin an exam once another student has submitted theirs.
- I actively work to identify and prevent cheating. Cheating or plagiarism on any assignment earns a zero on that assignment, and depending on severity, I may report the incident to the Student Judicial Board under the university's Honor Code, which carries additional penalties. Any other behavior I reasonably determine to be an attempt to gain an unfair advantage is also treated as cheating.

Quizzes

This course will have 11 quizzes. These quizzes will be administered through GAView and are due by 11:59p.m. of the date shown on the schedule. Students are allowed three attempts on quizzes, of which only their highest score will count. Quizzes will primarily cover recent material, though they may include any content discussed in lectures or the textbook up to that point. Quizzes not attempted by the due date receive a zero.

Exam and Quiz Makeup Policy

Makeup exams and quizzes are only given for university-approved excused absences. It is the student's responsibility to notify me of the excused absence and, in the case of a missed exam, to schedule a makeup. Makeup exams must be completed before the next class period; missing a Thursday exam means making it up before the following class begins. Quizzes are eligible for a makeup only if the excused absence covers the entire period the quiz was available. Makeup quizzes must be completed within one week of the original due date. Any exam or quiz not made up within the allowed timeframe will receive a zero. Note: weddings, travel, work, and technical issues are not excused absences.

Attendance

Attendance is not mandatory nor part of the grade. If you miss class, it's on you to find out what you missed and get caught up. That said, students who miss class often will not do well in this course.

Extra Credit

In an effort to remain fair to all students, no extra credit will be given under any circumstances nor will grades be rounded beyond the 0.5 threshold specified in the grading scale. For example, a score of 89.49 will earn a B whereas a 89.50 will earn an A.

Schedule

Below is an outline of the semester. I reserve the right to modify this schedule as needed.

Week	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
1		08/18 <i>Origins of Money</i>		08/20 <i>Key Markets</i>	
2	Quiz 1	08/25 <i>Classical Economics</i>		08/27 <i>Classical Economics</i>	
3	Quiz 2	09/1 <i>Keynesian Economics</i>		09/3 <i>Monetary Policy</i>	
4		09/8 <i>Federal Reserve</i>		09/10 No Class, Quiz 3	
5	Quiz 4	09/15 <i>Money Supply</i>		09/17 <i>Changing Money Supply</i>	
6	Quiz 5	09/22 <i>Changing Money Supply</i>		09/24 Exam 1	
7		09/29 <i>Federal Funds</i>		10/1 <i>Federal Funds</i>	
8	Quiz 6	10/6 <i>Time Value of Money</i>		10/8 <i>Bonds</i>	
9		10/13 No Class		10/15 <i>Bonds</i>	
10	Quiz 7	10/20 <i>Yield Curve</i>		10/22 <i>Yield Curve</i>	
11	Quiz 8	10/27 <i>Bank Runs</i>		10/29 <i>Stocks</i>	
12	Quiz 9	11/3 <i>Stocks</i>		11/05 Exam 2	
13		11/10 <i>Efficient Market Hypothesis</i>		11/12 <i>Prediction Markets</i>	
14	Quiz 10	11/17 <i>Prediction Markets</i>		11/19 <i>Foreign Exchange</i>	
15		11/24 <i>Foreign Exchange</i>		11/26 No Class	
16		12/1 <i>Cryptocurrency</i>	Quiz 11	12/3 <i>Cryptocurrency</i>	
17		12/08 No Class		12/10 Final Exam (8:00)	

University policies can be found at the link [here](#).